User Feedback and Actions

Research assistant product • User testing synthesis and response plan

1. User feedback

Manibrata Sen — Assistant Professor, IIT Bombay

Tested: Example project, new idea check, plan, invites

Liked

> *“The idea check citing actual papers is the part I’d trust. Most AI tools just make up references. The related directions using my ORCID record was the surprise: two of the five were things my group could start next month.”*

Confused by

> *“I didn’t understand why the commercial case was there for an academic project until I read the assumptions. And what’s the difference between Researcher and Lead for a PhD student who runs experiments but shouldn’t change the plan?”*

Wants

> *“Export the dashboard as a PDF for my funding agency’s progress report. That alone would get my students to log results.”*

Would he use it? For new project ideas, yes. For day-to-day tracking, only if students actually log results. That’s the real problem in my lab.

Vedanth Vijaykumar — MSc Student, IIT Bombay

Tested: Plan, drag-and-drop, results, notes, next steps

Liked

> *“Success criteria with numbers on every task. My supervisor always asks ‘how will you know it worked?’, and now that’s in the plan. Next steps reading my protocol notes and spotting that I’d changed the drying time was impressive.”*

Confused by

> *“Generating the plan took a minute and I almost refreshed. The progress message helped once I noticed it. Also, I wanted to log a partial result before a task was finished, but logging moves it to Done.”*

Wants

> *“A daily view: what’s mine, what’s due this week. And notes that support images. Half my lab notebook is photos of samples.”*

Would he use it? Yes, if my supervisor makes the team use it. Otherwise I’d go back to Notion out of habit.

Rajarshi Chakrabarti — Professor, IIT Bombay

Tested: Idea check (Goal = Product), unit economics, evidence, re-score

Liked

> *“Listing the assumptions behind the commercial score and letting us confirm or reject them with evidence is exactly how we run stage-gate reviews. The re-score after evidence felt honest; it went down when we rejected an assumption.”*

Concerned about

> *“Where does our data go? I can’t put unpublished product ideas into a tool that sends them to a free AI service that might train on them. I’d need that answered before using it at work.”*

Wants

> *“Patent search alongside papers, and a way to compare two ideas side by side.”*

Would he use it? For early screening, possibly. I’d pay for it only with clear data privacy and patent coverage.

2. Patterns across the three interviews

Trustworthy AI	The strongest value is grounded research: real papers, checkable assumptions, and suggestions informed by the team's own work.
Result logging is the weak link	The tool only stays useful if researchers and students record results. Partial results and a "my tasks this week" view could reduce friction.
Privacy blocks industry adoption	Users need clear assurances about where unpublished ideas and research data go, and whether AI providers train on them.
Funders need reports	PDF export for funding-agency progress reports was explicitly requested and is a strong candidate for the roadmap.

3. Changes and planned actions based on feedback

Feedback theme	Action / response	Status
Trustworthy research evidence	Real market data and research information were extracted using the Semantic Scholar and OpenAlex APIs to improve the trustworthiness of insights and provide stronger grounding.	Implemented
Reduce manual result logging	In v2, results will be updatable through voice to minimize the manual effort required to record experimental outcomes.	Planned for v2
Privacy of unpublished ideas and data	For production, the plan is to move to a paid AI tier whose providers do not train on API data, addressing the concern about research confidentiality.	Planned for production
PDF reports for funding agencies	PDF export was requested in feedback from two users. It is a strong next feature and is already included on the "What's next" slide.	On roadmap

Overall takeaway: The feedback validates the product's evidence-grounded idea assessment and research-planning value. The next priorities are lowering the effort of result capture, clearly communicating production data protections, and delivering exportable funder reports.